

CHRIS BROWN STREAMING ANALYSIS — PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Project Title: How has Chris Brown maintained superstar streaming resilience over a 20-year career despite repeated personal controversies, and what do his audio features and streaming patterns reveal about his commercial evolution?

Research Questions:

- How did the 2009 Rihanna incident visibly impact his streaming numbers and chart performance?
- What audio features define each of his career eras?
- What made Indigo his commercial peak?
- How does F.A.M.E compare to 11:11 given both won Grammys in different eras?
- Is the criticism around Brown reflected in early streaming data or are fans still showing up?

Data Sources

File	Source	What it contains
chrisbrown_song_spotify_streams_kwordb_20260520	Kwordb.net	Song level Spotify streams as of May 20 2026
chrisbrown_album_spotify_streams_kwordb_20260520	Kwordb.net	Album level Spotify streams as of May 20 2026
chrisbrown_youtube_song_views_20260520	Kwordb.net	YouTube views as of May 20 2026
chrisbrown_album_peakchartpositions_wikipedia	Wikipedia	Peak chart positions per album across 11 countries plus RIAA certifications
chrisbrown_billboard_hot100_billboard_20260520	Billboard.com	Song level Billboard Hot 100 chart history including debut date, peak position and weeks on chart
cleaned_dataset spotify_dataset datos_merged_1986_2023	Kaggle	Audio features including danceability, energy, valence, tempo for available Chris Brown songs
chrisbrown_discography_with_genres	Self-Compiled	Complete Chris Brown discography across 13 albums with 342 tracks, release years, labels and genre classifications

Data Collection Process:

Kwordb.net data: Manually copied and pasted streaming tables from Kwordb.net into Excel for song level streams, album level streams and YouTube views. All data reflects a snapshot as of May 20 2026. Files saved as xlsx format.

Wikipedia chart positions: Copied from the Chris Brown discography page on Wikipedia. Data represents peak chart positions at time of each album's release — these are permanent historical records that do not change over time.

Billboard Hot 100: Copied from Billboard.com showing Chris Brown's complete Hot 100 chart history including 125 songs with debut dates, peak positions and weeks on chart.

Kaggle audio features: Downloaded from Kaggle datasets containing Spotify audio features pulled before the November 2024 API restrictions. Coverage is limited to available tracks in existing datasets.

Discography with genres: Self compiled by manually researching each album tracklist from YouTube and Wikipedia. Genre classifications were determined through research using Google and AI assisted verification via Gemini. This table covers 13 albums and 333 tracks spanning 2005 to 2026.

Data Cleaning Process:

General cleaning across all datasets:

- Removed hyperlinks from all pasted data using Excel's Remove Hyperlinks function
- Removed Wikipedia footnote reference numbers in square brackets using Find and Replace
- Removed unnecessary text such as "Released:" labels from album details column
- Corrected text alignment issues caused by Excel misreading numeric values as dates or times
- Standardized date formats to dd/mm/yyyy across relevant columns
- Expanded country abbreviations to full country names in chart positions table
- Extracted label names from combined album details column using MID and FIND formula

Discography table specific:

- Removed duplicate entries where audio and official video versions of same song appeared
- Removed format information from album details
- Added edition column to distinguish original, deluxe, extended and bonus tracks

Data Limitations:

- Audio features coverage is incomplete; only available for approximately 40 unique Chris Brown songs due to Spotify API restrictions introduced in November 2024
- Kworl streaming data represents a point in time snapshot as of May 20 2026 and does not show historical streaming growth over time
- Genre classifications are manually assigned based on research and may reflect subjective interpretation
- Brown album streaming data is limited as the album was only released May 8 2026, approximately 12 days before data collection